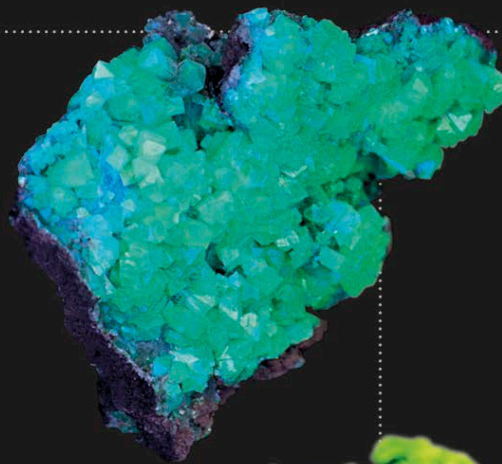


Fluorescent minerals

When seen under ultraviolet (UV) light, some crystals glow in eerie, psychedelic colours. First noted in 1824 in fluorite, the phenomenon is called fluorescence. It is unpredictable, as some specimens of a mineral fluoresce, while others, even from the same locality, do not. UV light is produced in long and short waves, and minerals may fluoresce in only one or the other or both.

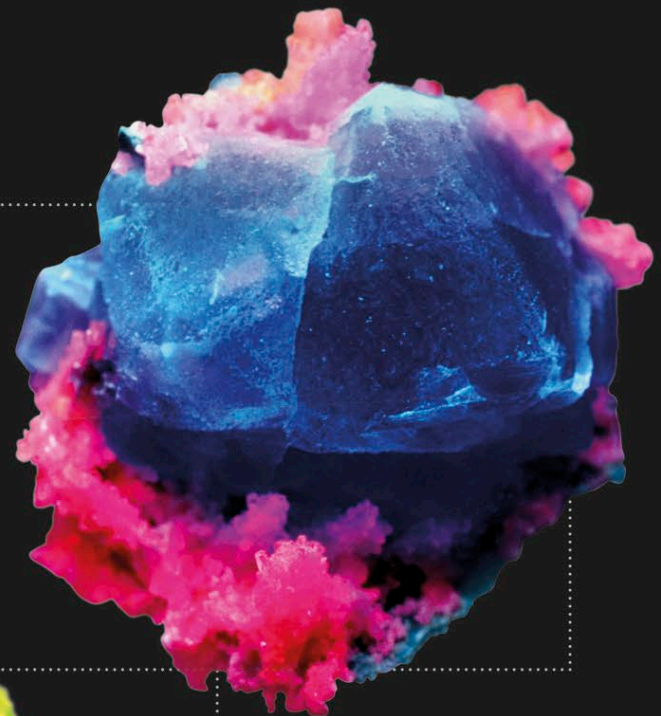
Adamite

The bright green fluorescence of adamite makes it popular with collectors. This specimen is from Mexico.



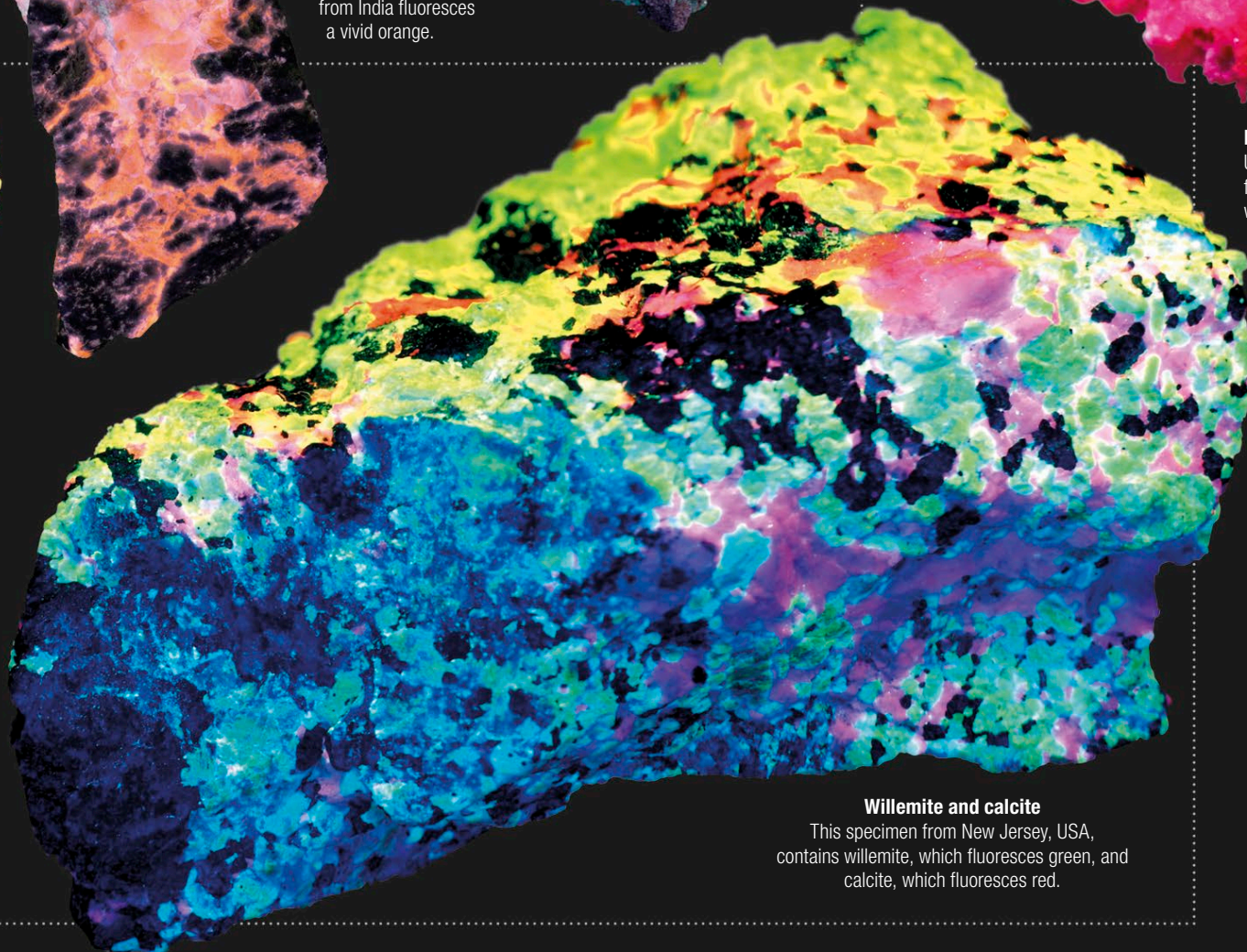
Sodalite

This sodalite specimen from India fluoresces a vivid orange.



Fluorite and calcite

Under UV light, this specimen's fluorite component turns blue, while its calcite appears red.



Willemite and calcite

This specimen from New Jersey, USA, contains willemite, which fluoresces green, and calcite, which fluoresces red.